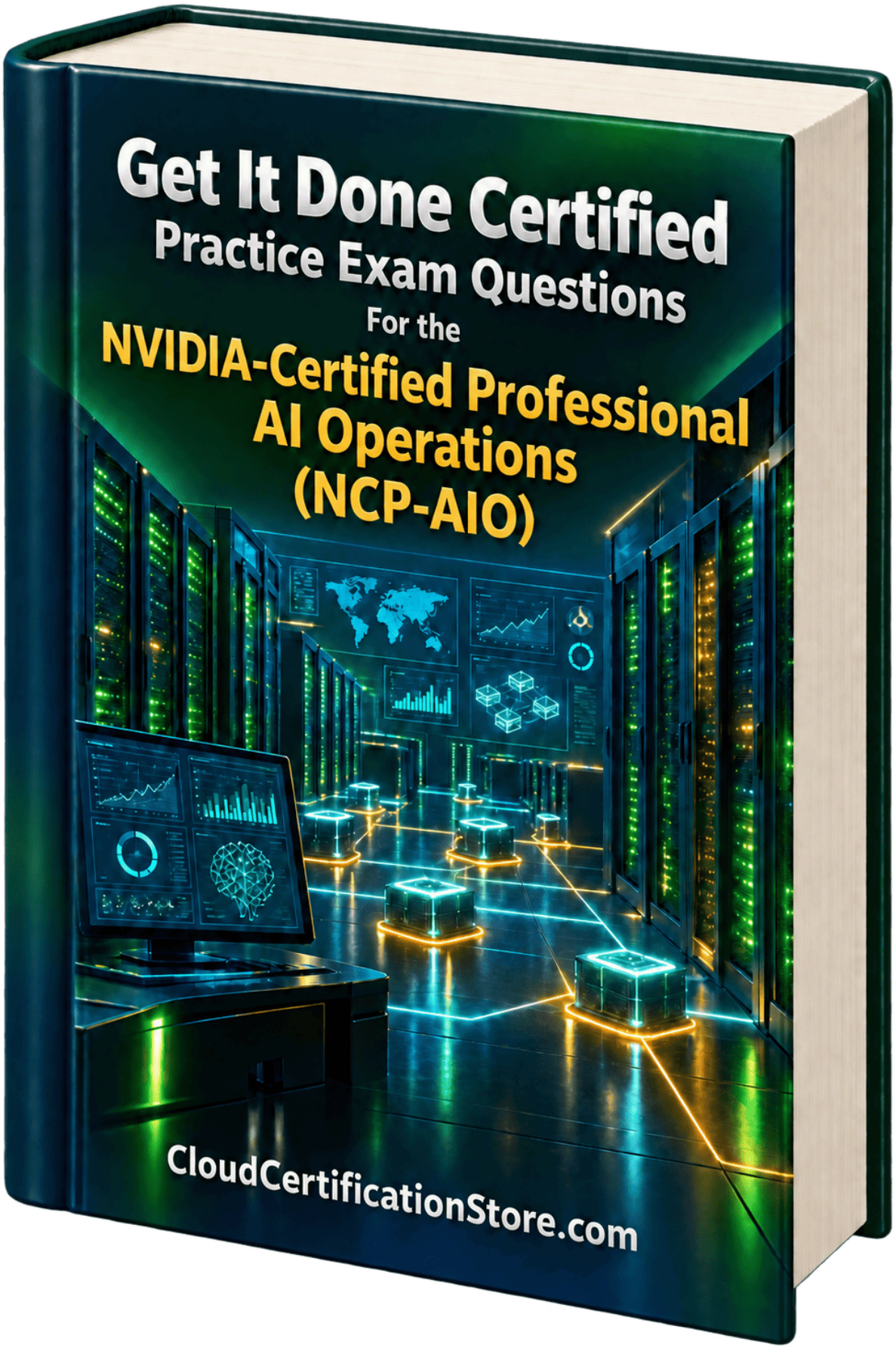

Get It Done Certified
Practice Exam Questions
For the
NVIDIA-Certified Professional
AI Operations
(NCP-AIO)
CloudCertificationStore.com

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Get It Done Certified Practice Exam Questions for the NVIDIA-Certified Professional: AI Operations (NCP-AIO)

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About the Book

The "Get It Done Certified Practice Exam Questions for the NVIDIA-Certified Professional: AI Operations (NCP-AIO)" unofficial guide is designed for professionals who operate NVIDIA-accelerated AI infrastructure and need scenario-based preparation for the NCP-AIO certification.

The certification validates the ability to administer, deploy, monitor, troubleshoot, and optimize AI infrastructure across managed clusters, workload schedulers, containers, networking, storage, and GPU platforms.

This edition emphasizes operational judgment. It asks you to interpret observable state, isolate the controlling layer, apply supported changes with a limited blast radius, and prove recovery through repeatable validation.

The practice exams cover the current published domains: Administration, Workload Management, Installation and Deployment, and Troubleshooting and Optimization. Each set also includes hands-on lab exercises aligned to the performance-based skills described by NVIDIA.

Instead of relying on memorization, the guide uses realistic situations involving Base Command Manager, Slurm, Kubernetes, Run:ai, Fleet Command, NVIDIA GPU Cloud containers, telemetry, Multi-Instance GPU, Data Processing Units, storage, and high-speed interconnects.

Every multiple-choice item includes a clearly marked answer, a technical rationale, and explanations for every distractor. Every lab provides a scenario, tasks, success criteria, evidence requirements, and cleanup expectations.

What You Will Get:

- Exam-blueprint aligned practice sets with scenario-based operational decisions.
- Detailed explanations for the correct answer and every incorrect option.
- Hands-on exercises for Slurm troubleshooting, Kubernetes GPU workloads, and Base Command Manager node onboarding.

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- A domain-based final review checklist and readiness scorecard.

Aligned to the Current NCP-AIO Domains:

- Administration (23%)
- Workload Management (23%)
- Installation and Deployment (31%)
- Troubleshooting and Optimization (23%)

The current study guide and its published objectives were used for this edition. Certification objectives and product behavior can change, so verify the official NVIDIA certification resources before the exam.

This book is ideal for AI infrastructure administrators, platform engineers, cluster operators, site reliability engineers, DevOps engineers, and architects responsible for NVIDIA-accelerated environments.

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About the Author

CloudCertificationStore.com is a multi-cloud certification preparation brand for serious technology professionals. It specializes in structured, explanation-driven practice exams for AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud, NVIDIA, Snowflake, and other cloud, AI, and database certifications.

Our materials are designed for engineers, architects, and technical leaders who want more than memorization: they want real understanding.

Unlike memorization-focused study materials, CloudCertificationStore delivers:

- Exam-blueprint aligned question sets
- Detailed rationales for every answer
- Enterprise-grade, scenario-based depth
- Cross-domain architecture coverage
- Clear mapping to real-world cloud workloads

Every practice set is designed to build decision-making skill rather than answer-key memorization. We focus on realistic trade-offs, verification, governance, workflow quality, and practical use of AI in professional settings.

If your goal is to prepare confidently while strengthening practical cloud and AI judgment, CloudCertificationStore was built for you.

Our practice questions are designed to closely reflect the style, difficulty, and domain coverage commonly expected in professional certification exams. Many learners have shared that the topics, scenarios, and decision patterns covered in these practice materials helped them feel more confident and better prepared for the exam. This book is designed to reinforce the skills measured in the official study guide through original, scenario-based questions, detailed explanations, and practical security reasoning. It is not based on real exam questions, proprietary exam content, or confidential testing material.

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How to Study for this Exam

NCP-AIO is both a knowledge exam and an operational exam. Strong preparation requires more than recognizing product names: you must interpret live system state, choose a safe action, execute it from the Linux command line, and prove that the platform is healthy afterward.

The current NVIDIA exam page lists 30 multiple-choice questions and three hands-on lab exercises in a 120-minute sitting. Use the multiple-choice practice and lab rehearsal together so recognition and execution develop at the same pace.

The strongest answer is usually not simply an action that could work. It is the action that addresses the controlling failure mode while preserving evidence, limiting blast radius, following supported configuration paths, and creating a measurable validation point.

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The Four-Pass Study Method: Learn, Apply, Test, Repair

Pass 1 - Learn. Read each question and explanation carefully. Convert the important decision into a short rule in your own words: when this condition is true, choose this action because the alternatives fail at a different layer.

Pass 2 - Apply. Reproduce the decision in a safe lab. Inspect Kubernetes events, Slurm state, Base Command Manager provisioning information, GPU telemetry, container runtime configuration, storage behavior, and interconnect health.

Pass 3 - Test. Work through mixed-domain questions and labs without looking at the answers. Capture commands, logs, metrics, and screenshots that prove the outcome rather than relying on memory.

Pass 4 - Repair. For every miss or failed lab, identify the exact diagnostic, configuration, sequencing, or validation rule that was missing. Correct that rule and repeat the smallest representative test.

A Compact Exam-Thinking Checklist for AI Operators

Identify the actual failure domain. Decide whether the issue belongs to provisioning, scheduling, GPU health, containers, storage, networking, identity, policy, or application behavior.

Find the binding constraint. Look for availability, tenant isolation, compatibility, rollback, performance, security, maintenance window, or evidence requirements that change the correct action.

Inspect before changing. Preserve the drain reason, pod events, service logs, health telemetry, configuration state, and workload evidence needed to diagnose and verify recovery.

Use the managed source of truth. Prefer Base Command Manager categories and images, Kubernetes declarative resources, Run:ai policy, and scheduler configuration over undocumented node-local edits.

Limit the blast radius. Drain one node, use a staged rollout, test one workload, or validate one representative pool before broad deployment.

Follow the complete lifecycle. Detection is not recovery. Include correction, validation, rescheduling, cleanup, documentation, and rollback readiness.

How to Eliminate Sophisticated Distractors

Reject changes at an unrelated layer. A scheduler symptom is not fixed by changing a registry password, and a GPU health fault is not fixed by increasing application logging alone.

Reject destructive action before diagnosis. Deleting state, reimaging nodes, or restarting an entire cluster can erase evidence and expand impact.

Reject access without least privilege. A working credential or privileged container does not prove that broad access is appropriate.

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Reject scale before evidence. Broad rollout, cluster-wide restart, and global policy changes are weak first actions when a smaller validation path exists.

Prefer explicit success criteria. The stronger option normally states how the operator will know the fault is corrected and the platform is ready for workloads.

How to Use the Explanations and Labs

For every question, explain why the correct option satisfies the scenario and identify the specific technical flaw in every distractor. A correct letter chosen for the wrong reason still represents a study gap.

For every lab, record the initial state, commands or configuration changes, evidence collected, validation result, and cleanup. Repeat failed labs until the success criteria are reproducible.

Acronym Reference for This Edition

Graphics Processing Unit (GPU); Base Command Manager (BCM); NVIDIA Data Center GPU Manager (DCGM); NVIDIA System Management (NVSM); Multi-Instance GPU (MIG); NVIDIA GPU Cloud (NGC); Data Processing Unit (DPU); NVIDIA Collective Communications Library (NCCL); and Non-Uniform Memory Access (NUMA).

The Highest-Leverage Habit for NCP-AIO

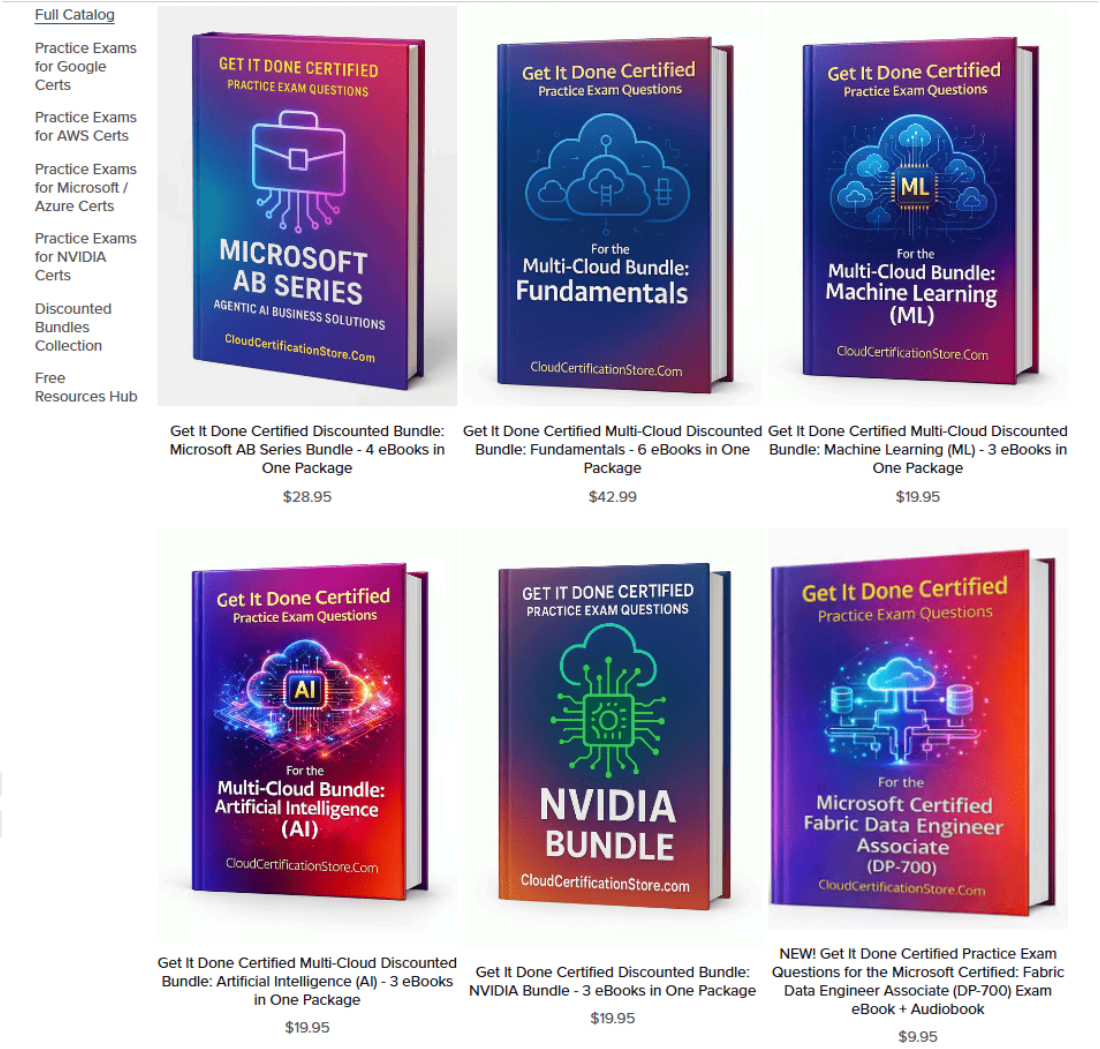
Before reading the options, restate the problem in one sentence: what is failing, which layer controls it, and what evidence will prove recovery?

Study the operational decision, not the answer letter.

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Practice Exam Questions

Choose the best answer for each scenario before reading the explanation. Complete the hands-on exercises in an authorized lab and retain evidence that demonstrates the stated success criteria.

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Practice Exam 1

Question 1

A BCM-managed edge site shows a stale heartbeat immediately after its management VLAN gateway changed. What should the operator verify before touching workloads?

A. Evict each pod at the site and recreate it from the same manifest

B. Check reachability from the management service to the site endpoint

C. Move unrelated Slurm jobs to another partition to force a refresh

D. Replace the site certificate before confirming that packets reach the gateway

Correct Answer: B. Check reachability from the management service to the site endpoint

Verifying that the management service can actually reach the site endpoint over the new gateway isolates whether the stale heartbeat is a routing break introduced by the VLAN change rather than a workload fault, and a failed probe confirms the gateway change broke the path before anything at the site is touched.

Why not the other options?

A. **Evict each pod at the site and recreate it from the same manifest** — Evicting and recreating each pod treats this as a workload problem when the symptom points to a network path change, and rescheduling onto a site BCM cannot currently reach would just leave the new pods unreachable too.

C. **Move unrelated Slurm jobs to another partition to force a refresh** — Moving unrelated Slurm jobs to another partition never touches the management VLAN or the new gateway, so it cannot restore the heartbeat and instead disrupts scheduling elsewhere.

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D. **Replace the site certificate before confirming that packets reach the gateway** — Swapping the site certificate addresses TLS trust, not IP reachability, and doing it before packets are even confirmed to reach the gateway risks locking out access over a still-broken path.

Question 2

A validated service must reach ten edge sites, but the first canary has not yet met its latency threshold. Which rollout decision is safest?

A. Pause the rollout and inspect canary health against the acceptance threshold

B. Delete the previous release before collecting the canary measurements

C. Push the image to the remaining sites so that versions converge immediately

D. Increase GPU count at each site without changing the release strategy

Correct Answer: A. Pause the rollout and inspect canary health against the acceptance threshold

Pausing lets the operator compare the canary's measured latency against the defined acceptance threshold before any of the other nine sites receive the new image, so the rollout resumes once the canary actually clears the gate.

Why not the other options?

B. **Delete the previous release before collecting the canary measurements** — Deleting the previous release before the canary result is confirmed removes the one known-good fallback while the new image's latency is still unproven.

C. **Push the image to the remaining sites so that versions converge immediately** — Pushing to the remaining sites so versions converge ignores that the canary has not cleared its threshold, propagating a possibly under-performing image to nine untested edge sites at once.

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D. **Increase GPU count at each site without changing the release strategy** — Adding GPU count changes capacity, not the release gate, and does nothing to address whether the canary's measured latency meets the acceptance threshold.

Question 3

A Slurm node is DRAIN because a health check reported a failed GPU, while the administrator has just replaced the board. What is the next operational step?

A. Reinstall the slurmctld controller and purge its StateSaveLocation to clear the DRAIN flag

B. Clear the DRAIN flag while the failed health check is still present during recovery

C. Move the node into a higher-priority partition without testing the GPU

D. Run the node health validation and return it to service after the check passes

Correct Answer: D. Run the node health validation and return it to service after the check passes

Re-running the node health validation against the newly installed board is what actually proves the GPU that triggered DRAIN is now sound, and a passing result is the trigger for clearing the state and letting Slurm schedule jobs there again.

Why not the other options?

A. **Reinstall the slurmctld controller and purge its StateSaveLocation to clear the DRAIN flag** — Reinstalling the controller host discards visibility into the node's DRAIN history without ever testing the board that was just replaced.

B. **Clear the DRAIN flag while the failed health check is still present during recovery** — Clearing DRAIN while the health check is still reporting a failure would put jobs back on a node whose replaced GPU has not been confirmed working.

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C. **Move the node into a higher-priority partition without testing the GPU** — Moving the node into a higher-priority partition without testing the GPU gives untested hardware first claim on incoming jobs.

Question 4

A short interactive job is repeatedly waiting behind multi-day training reservations. Which scheduling control addresses the contention directly?

A. Place interactive work in a policy-defined partition or QoS with an appropriate time limit

B. Disable backfill scheduling in slurm.conf so bf_interval no longer lets short jobs fill idle gaps

C. Add more login shells on the management node and leave GPU policy unchanged at acceptance

D. Give interactive users unrestricted priority over any training reservation

Correct Answer: A. Place interactive work in a policy-defined partition or QoS with an appropriate time limit

Giving interactive work a policy-defined partition or QoS with a short time limit removes it from the same queue as the multi-day reservations, so short jobs get scheduled against their own bounded resources instead of waiting behind long-running allocations.

Why not the other options?

B. **Disable backfill scheduling in slurm.conf so bf_interval no longer lets short jobs fill idle gaps** — Disabling backfill removes the mechanism that lets short jobs fill idle gaps around the long reservations, making the wait worse rather than better.

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C. **Add more login shells on the management node and leave GPU policy unchanged at acceptance** — Adding login shells changes interactive access to the management node, not which partition or QoS interactive jobs are scheduled against.

D. **Give interactive users unrestricted priority over any training reservation** — Giving interactive users unrestricted priority over training reservations would preempt or starve the multi-day jobs, trading one contention problem for another.

Question 5

Two equally funded teams share a GPU cluster, but one submits many small jobs and consumes most idle capacity. What should the administrator configure?

A. Increase the MaxMemPerNode limit on each job regardless of project usage history

B. Reserve the entire cluster for whichever team submits the first sbatch job

C. Apply fair-share or equivalent project-level usage weighting in the scheduler policy

D. Disable accounting so that the scheduler cannot see historical consumption

Correct Answer: C. Apply fair-share or equivalent project-level usage weighting in the scheduler policy

A fair-share weighting ties the scheduler's priority decisions to each project's accounted usage, so the team that has been consuming most of the idle capacity accrues progressively lower priority until the other team's share catches up.

Why not the other options?

A. **Increase the MaxMemPerNode limit on each job regardless of project usage history** — Raising the memory limit on each job changes how much a job

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can request, not how the scheduler ranks jobs by the two teams' prior consumption.

B. **Reserve the entire cluster for whichever team submits the first sbatch job** — Reserving the entire cluster for whichever team submits first hands that team permanent priority instead of balancing usage over time.

D. **Disable accounting so that the scheduler cannot see historical consumption** — Disabling accounting removes the usage history fair-share actually depends on, making the imbalance impossible to detect or correct.

Question 6

A maintenance test must run on three named nodes between 02:00 and 03:00 without admitting new production work there. Which mechanism fits?

A. Change the default partition to maintenance and leave it enabled permanently

B. Create a time-bounded reservation for the named nodes and maintenance account

C. Set each node in the data center to DRAIN for the whole night

D. Edit each sbatch script to request a different GPU model instead

Correct Answer: B. Create a time-bounded reservation for the named nodes and maintenance account

A reservation scoped to those three node names and to a maintenance account restricts admission during that hour to the maintenance jobs, leaving the nodes unavailable to production submissions outside the account and releasing them automatically afterward.

Why not the other options?

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A. **Change the default partition to maintenance and leave it enabled permanently** — Changing the default partition to maintenance and leaving it enabled permanently affects every job's default target, not just the three named nodes during a one-hour window.

C. **Set each node in the data center to DRAIN for the whole night** — Draining each node in the data center for the whole night takes far more capacity offline than the three nodes the test actually needs.

D. **Edit each sbatch script to request a different GPU model instead** — Editing each user's job to request a different GPU model does not reserve the three named nodes or stop other users from landing on them during the test window.

Question 7

A design review finds that two supposedly redundant inference services share one top-of-rack switch. What should be recorded as the corrective design action?

A. Increase replica count in the deployment spec without changing the switch placement

B. Rotate the inference service's TLS credentials and API tokens before correcting the physical topology

C. Place the replicas across independent failure domains and verify the placement rule

D. Raise the container CPU limit so the switch has more headroom during path validation

Correct Answer: C. Place the replicas across independent failure domains and verify the placement rule

Spreading the replicas across independent racks and switches removes the single top-of-rack switch as a shared point of failure, and verifying the placement rule

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(such as anti-affinity) is what confirms the two services no longer depend on the same uplink.

Why not the other options?

A. **Increase replica count in the deployment spec without changing the switch placement** — Adding more replicas behind the same switch increases the count without removing the shared dependency the design review flagged.

B. **Rotate the inference service's TLS credentials and API tokens before correcting the physical topology** — Rotating service credentials addresses access control, not the physical topology problem the review found.

D. **Raise the container CPU limit so the switch has more headroom during path validation** — Raising the container CPU limit gives more compute headroom but does nothing about the shared switch both services still sit behind.

Question 8

Training traffic is saturating the same network path used by cluster administration. Which design change reduces the operational coupling?

A. Use separate management and data-plane paths with documented routing and capacity

B. Move the API server onto the busiest shared training network interface

C. Compress each etcd and control-plane message with gzip before changing the network topology

D. Disable telemetry during training so the shared link appears quieter against link counters

Correct Answer: A. Use separate management and data-plane paths with documented routing and capacity

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Giving administrative traffic its own physical or logical path removes it from contention with training bandwidth, so BCM commands and health checks keep working even when the training network is saturated.

Why not the other options?

B. **Move the API server onto the busiest shared training network interface** — Moving the API server onto the busiest training interface puts administrative traffic directly on the link that is already saturated, worsening the coupling.

C. **Compress each etcd and control-plane message with gzip before changing the network topology** — Compressing each control message shrinks their size but leaves them sharing the same congested training path.

D. **Disable telemetry during training so the shared link appears quieter against link counters** — Disabling telemetry during training hides the saturation from monitoring dashboards without actually separating the administrative path from the data path.

Question 9

A tenant should receive its guaranteed GPU share but may borrow idle capacity from other tenants. Which policy model is appropriate?

A. Use image tags as the sole mechanism for enforcing resource ownership during promotion

B. Grant cluster-admin permissions to each tenant so it can self-balance

C. Use a quota with a borrowing or reclaim rule for unused capacity

D. Hard-partition each GPU permanently so idle capacity cannot be shared

Correct Answer: C. Use a quota with a borrowing or reclaim rule for unused capacity

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A quota that defines a guaranteed floor alongside a borrowing or reclaim rule lets the tenant use idle GPUs from others when they are free, while ensuring that capacity is reclaimed once the owning tenant needs its guaranteed share back.

Why not the other options?

A. **Use image tags as the sole mechanism for enforcing resource ownership during promotion** — Image tags identify container versions, not resource ownership, so they cannot enforce a GPU quota or a borrowing policy.

B. **Grant cluster-admin permissions to each tenant so it can self-balance** — Granting cluster-admin permissions to each tenant removes the isolation the quota model depends on and lets any tenant override another's guarantee.

D. **Hard-partition each GPU permanently so idle capacity cannot be shared** — Hard-partitioning each GPU permanently prevents the idle-borrowing behavior the requirement explicitly asks for.

Question 10

A department wants several projects under one organizational budget with delegated project administrators. What should be established first?

A. Use a shared root password so delegated administrators have identical access

B. Give each project the owner ClusterRole binding at the cluster root scope

C. Create an organizational hierarchy with scoped roles and aggregate quota

D. Copy one project quota manually to each namespace and avoid hierarchy

Correct Answer: C. Create an organizational hierarchy with scoped roles and aggregate quota

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Establishing the organizational hierarchy first lets the aggregate budget be enforced at the department level while scoped roles let each delegated administrator manage their own project underneath it.

Why not the other options?

A. **Use a shared root password so delegated administrators have identical access** — A shared root password gives every delegated administrator identical, unscoped access instead of the per-project boundaries the department is asking for.

B. **Give each project the owner ClusterRole binding at the cluster root scope** — Giving each project the owner role at the cluster root erases the delegation boundary and lets any project consume the whole department's budget.

D. **Copy one project quota manually to each namespace and avoid hierarchy** — Manually copying one project's quota to each namespace skips the hierarchy entirely and leaves no aggregate budget enforced across projects.

Question 11

A Kubernetes pod requests a GPU but is scheduled onto a CPU node and exposes no accelerator device. What is the first configuration check?

A. Raise the pod's priorityClassName value so it can bypass the device plugin's resource accounting

B. Confirm the pod requests the vendor GPU resource and that a device plugin advertises it

C. Mount the host filesystem read-write and let the process discover devices itself

D. Add a GPU library inside the container without changing the pod resource request during reconciliation

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Correct Answer: B. Confirm the pod requests the vendor GPU resource and that a device plugin advertises it

Checking that the pod manifest actually declares the vendor GPU resource and that a device plugin on a GPU-capable node is advertising it explains why the scheduler placed the pod on a CPU node in the first place, since without both pieces the scheduler has no signal to route it correctly.

Why not the other options?

A. **Raise the pod's priorityClassName value so it can bypass the device plugin's resource accounting** — Raising pod priority changes the order pods get scheduled in, not whether the pod's resource request or the device plugin actually names a GPU.

C. **Mount the host filesystem read-write and let the process discover devices itself** — Mounting the host filesystem read-write does not inject the accelerator device and opens an unrelated security exposure.

D. **Add a GPU library inside the container without changing the pod resource request during reconciliation** — Adding a GPU library inside the container leaves the pod's resource request unchanged, so the scheduler still has no reason to place it on a GPU node.

Question 12

A GPU pod remains Pending even though one node appears idle in the console. Which evidence should be compared first?

A. Restart the kube-apiserver and kube-scheduler pods before identifying the unsatisfied predicate

B. Change the container's entrypoint command so the scheduler ignores taints and node affinity

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C. Delete the pod repeatedly until one attempt happens to land during reconciliation

D. Read the scheduler events alongside node labels, taints, and allocatable GPU capacity

Correct Answer: D. Read the scheduler events alongside node labels, taints, and allocatable GPU capacity

Cross-referencing the scheduler's FailedScheduling events with that node's labels, taints, and allocatable GPU count identifies exactly which predicate the idle-looking node fails, since console idleness does not surface taints or capacity already committed elsewhere.

Why not the other options?

A. **Restart the kube-apiserver and kube-scheduler pods before identifying the unsatisfied predicate** — Restarting the control plane does not reveal which scheduling predicate the pod is failing and discards the very events that would show it.

B. **Change the container's entrypoint command so the scheduler ignores taints and node affinity** — Changing the container command does not alter how the scheduler evaluates node constraints for the pod.

C. **Delete the pod repeatedly until one attempt happens to land during reconciliation** — Repeatedly deleting and recreating the pod hopes for a lucky placement instead of identifying the constraint that is actually blocking it.

Question 13

A node pool must accept accelerator workloads but reject general-purpose pods. Which Kubernetes control expresses that intent?

A. Grant the workload service account permission to bypass the scheduler

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B. Use a container image name as a substitute for node scheduling policy during promotion

C. Label each namespace as GPU-enabled and omit node-side admission policy

D. Use a taint on the GPU nodes and a matching toleration on approved workloads

Correct Answer: D. Use a taint on the GPU nodes and a matching toleration on approved workloads

Tainting the GPU nodes keeps ordinary pods from scheduling there by default, while giving the approved GPU workloads a matching toleration lets them land on that pool without opening it to everything else.

Why not the other options?

A. **Grant the workload service account permission to bypass the scheduler** — Granting a service account permission to bypass the scheduler skips node-level admission entirely and defeats the pool's isolation goal.

B. **Use a container image name as a substitute for node scheduling policy during promotion** — An image name has no effect on where the scheduler places a pod, so it cannot keep general-purpose workloads off the GPU nodes.

C. **Label each namespace as GPU-enabled and omit node-side admission policy** — Labeling each namespace as GPU-enabled without a node-side taint does nothing to stop non-GPU pods from landing on those nodes.

Question 14

A training job requires a particular compute capability and memory size. Which scheduling data should the manifest use?

A. Request no GPU resource in the pod spec and inspect nvidia-smi output after the process starts

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B. Select nodes with a verified GPU label and request the required resource shape

C. Rely on the latest image tag to select the desired hardware automatically

D. Pin the job's nodeSelector to the control-plane node because it runs the newest kubelet version

Correct Answer: B. Select nodes with a verified GPU label and request the required resource shape

Matching the manifest's node selector to a label reflecting the verified GPU model, combined with a resource request sized to the needed memory, is what guarantees the scheduler places the job on hardware that truly has the required compute capability.

Why not the other options?

A. **Request no GPU resource in the pod spec and inspect nvidia-smi output after the process starts** — Requesting no GPU and inspecting the device after the process starts lets the job land on hardware that may lack the needed compute capability before anyone notices.

C. **Rely on the latest image tag to select the desired hardware automatically** — The latest image tag describes container contents, not the physical GPU model or memory a node actually provides.

D. **Pin the job's nodeSelector to the control-plane node because it runs the newest kubelet version** — Pinning the job to the API server targets a control-plane node rather than a GPU worker with the required capability.

Question 15

A new inference image must replace a live deployment while failed replicas remain out of service. Which release strategy is appropriate?

A. Delete the deployment first and recreate it without a health gate

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B. Send traffic to each new pod before its model server reports ready

C. Change the node image while leaving the application rollout untracked

D. Use a rolling update with readiness probes and a bounded unavailable count

Correct Answer: D. Use a rolling update with readiness probes and a bounded unavailable count

Readiness probes stop traffic from reaching a replica until its model server actually reports ready, and a bounded max-unavailable count caps how many old replicas get replaced at once, together keeping failed new replicas out of rotation while the rest of the deployment stays live.

Why not the other options?

A. **Delete the deployment first and recreate it without a health gate** — Deleting the deployment first with no health gate takes the service fully offline and removes any check on whether new replicas actually come up healthy.

B. **Send traffic to each new pod before its model server reports ready** — Sending traffic to each new pod before its model server reports ready routes requests to replicas that may not yet be able to serve them.

C. **Change the node image while leaving the application rollout untracked** — Changing the node image while leaving the application rollout untracked means replica health during the switch is never actually monitored.

Question 16

Operators need fleet-wide GPU temperature, utilization, and error counters in one view. Which telemetry foundation should they deploy?

A. Collect DCGM-exporter metrics and centralize them in the monitoring system

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B. Poll each user container's metrics endpoint manually and discard the node identity

C. Parse application logs as a substitute for hardware counters at acceptance

D. Use the node CPU load average as a proxy for GPU accelerator health

Correct Answer: A. Collect DCGM-exporter metrics and centralize them in the monitoring system

DCGM-exporter reads the GPU's native counters for temperature, utilization, and error state directly from the driver, so centralizing that feed in the monitoring system is what produces a single fleet-wide view of exactly those signals.

Why not the other options?

B. **Poll each user container's metrics endpoint manually and discard the node identity** — Polling each user container manually discards which physical node and GPU a reading came from, defeating a fleet-wide view.

C. **Parse application logs as a substitute for hardware counters at acceptance** — Application logs do not carry the hardware counters DCGM reads from the driver, so parsing logs cannot substitute for that telemetry.

D. **Use the node CPU load average as a proxy for GPU accelerator health** — CPU load does not reflect GPU temperature, utilization, or error counters, so it cannot stand in for accelerator-specific telemetry.

Question 17

Prometheus discovers Kubernetes nodes but sees no GPU series. Which component is most likely missing?

A. A larger container registry because metrics are stored as images during promotion

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B. A GPU metrics exporter with a scrape target and service discovery configuration

C. A second kube-scheduler instance that duplicates the existing node inventory list

D. A higher priorityClassName assigned to the Prometheus server deployment

Correct Answer: B. A GPU metrics exporter with a scrape target and service discovery configuration

Without a GPU exporter such as DCGM-exporter running on the nodes and registered as a scrape target, Prometheus has node-level discovery but nothing emitting GPU metric series for it to actually collect.

Why not the other options?

A. **A larger container registry because metrics are stored as images during promotion** — A larger container registry stores images, not time-series metrics, and adding one has no effect on the missing GPU series.

C. **A second kube-scheduler instance that duplicates the existing node inventory list** — A second scheduler duplicates pod placement decisions and does not emit or expose any GPU metrics.

D. **A higher priorityClassName assigned to the Prometheus server deployment** — A higher pod priority class affects whether the Prometheus pod itself gets scheduled, not whether any GPU metric series exists to scrape.

Question 18

A new BCM management environment is being commissioned for a GPU cluster. Which early task establishes a reliable foundation?

A. Disable the BCM provisioning and cmdaemon logs to keep the initial node imaging quiet

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B. Assign production Slurm partitions before any node passes BCM acceptance checks

C. Install application workloads before the management plane has an inventory during recovery

D. Define management networking, credentials, and the intended node inventory before imaging nodes

Correct Answer: D. Define management networking, credentials, and the intended node inventory before imaging nodes

Defining the management network layout, credentials, and the intended node inventory before any node is imaged gives BCM the addressing and identity information it needs to provision each node correctly the first time, instead of discovering gaps after nodes are already deployed.

Why not the other options?

A. **Disable the BCM provisioning and cmdaemon logs to keep the initial node imaging quiet** — Disabling provisioning logs removes the record needed to troubleshoot problems that show up early in commissioning.

B. **Assign production Slurm partitions before any node passes BCM acceptance checks** — Assigning production partitions before any node has passed acceptance puts unverified hardware directly into service.

C. **Install application workloads before the management plane has an inventory during recovery** — Installing application workloads before the management plane even has an inventory means there is no verified node list for BCM to target.

Question 19

Twenty identical GPU servers need the same operating system, drivers, and baseline configuration. What is the scalable approach?

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A. Configure each host by hand and record differences in personal notes under current policy

B. Copy a running node's root filesystem with rsync while its services stay active

C. Use a versioned image or provisioning profile and apply it to the node group

D. Let each node select packages independently from the public internet

Correct Answer: C. Use a versioned image or provisioning profile and apply it to the node group

A versioned image or provisioning profile applied uniformly to the node group guarantees all twenty servers receive the identical, recorded OS and driver combination, and future drift can be diagnosed against that same recorded version.

Why not the other options?

A. **Configure each host by hand and record differences in personal notes under current policy** — Configuring each host by hand and tracking differences in personal notes does not scale to twenty servers and leaves no authoritative record of what is actually installed.

B. **Copy a running node's root filesystem with rsync while its services stay active** — Copying a running root filesystem while services are active risks capturing an inconsistent, mid-write state rather than a clean baseline.

D. **Let each node select packages independently from the public internet** — Letting each node pull packages independently from the public internet produces twenty servers that can end up with different package versions instead of one baseline.

Question 20

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A replacement server has passed hardware inspection and must join the managed compute inventory. What should happen before scheduling user work?

A. Enroll it, apply the approved profile, and run node acceptance checks

B. Start a long training run to test the node under uncontrolled load

C. Add it directly to a production partition without a health check

D. Give it a permanent exception from the fleet's approved image and driver policy

Correct Answer: A. Enroll it, apply the approved profile, and run node acceptance checks

Enrolling the server, applying the same approved profile the fleet runs, and passing node acceptance checks confirms the new server matches the fleet's tested baseline before it is trusted with user jobs.

Why not the other options?

B. **Start a long training run to test the node under uncontrolled load** — Starting a long training run under uncontrolled load puts production work on the node before its baseline configuration has even been confirmed.

C. **Add it directly to a production partition without a health check** — Adding it directly to a production partition without a health check skips confirming that the node matches the fleet's approved configuration.

D. **Give it a permanent exception from the fleet's approved image and driver policy** — Granting a permanent exception from image and driver policy means the node never has to match the tested baseline the rest of the fleet runs.

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Hands-On Lab 1: Recover a drained GPU node

Scenario: A scheduled workload remains pending because one compute node is in DRAIN state after an intermittent hardware alert.
Objective
Troubleshoot a Slurm-managed NVIDIA AI cluster through Base Command Manager and prove workload recovery.
Suggested environment
Use an authorized non-production lab with Linux command-line access, representative NVIDIA hardware or supported virtualization, documented credentials, and a rollback path. Do not perform disruptive steps on an active production cluster.
Tasks
1. Use Base Command Manager to verify the node identity, category, software image, and current health state.
2. Use Slurm commands such as sinfo and scontrol show node to capture the drain reason and affected jobs.
3. Correlate the reason with NVIDIA Data Center GPU Manager diagnostics and system logs.
4. Correct the root cause, resume the node through the supported workflow, and submit a short validation job.
Required evidence
Capture the initial state, commands or configuration changes, relevant events and logs, health or performance output, final state, and cleanup result. Redact credentials and sensitive infrastructure data.

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Success criteria

The node returns to an allocatable state, the validation job completes on the intended Graphics Processing Unit, and the incident record includes before-and-after evidence.

Cleanup and rollback

Remove temporary workloads and credentials, return test resources to the approved baseline, and document any condition that requires escalation instead of further local changes.

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Hands-On Lab 2: Run and validate a basic GPU workload

Scenario: A Kubernetes cluster is ready, but no tenant workload has yet proved end-to-end GPU scheduling.

Objective

Deploy and validate a Kubernetes GPU workload while collecting scheduler, runtime, and telemetry evidence.

Suggested environment

Use an authorized non-production lab with Linux command-line access, representative NVIDIA hardware or supported virtualization, documented credentials, and a rollback path. Do not perform disruptive steps on an active production cluster.

Tasks

1. Confirm that a worker advertises the nvidia.com/gpu resource and that the NVIDIA device plugin is healthy.
2. Create a namespace and submit a pod that requests one GPU and runs a minimal device-visibility command.
3. Inspect events, logs, node placement, and device visibility from inside the container.
4. Delete the test resources and confirm that the GPU returns to the allocatable pool.

Required evidence

Capture the initial state, commands or configuration changes, relevant events and logs, health or performance output, final state, and cleanup result. Redact credentials and sensitive infrastructure data.

Success criteria

The pod reaches Completed, reports the expected GPU, and leaves no stale workload or resource claim.

Cleanup and rollback

Remove temporary workloads and credentials, return test resources to the approved baseline, and document any condition that requires escalation instead of further local changes.

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Hands-On Lab 3: Add a replacement compute node

Scenario: A replacement server must join an existing Base Command Manager cluster without disturbing production nodes.

Objective

Add or reconcile a compute node through Base Command Manager and complete production acceptance checks.

Suggested environment

Use an authorized non-production lab with Linux command-line access, representative NVIDIA hardware or supported virtualization, documented credentials, and a rollback path. Do not perform disruptive steps on an active production cluster.

Tasks

1. Record the approved node name, management address, network interfaces, hardware profile, and target category.
2. Add the node in Base Command Manager, assign the validated software image and category, and begin provisioning.
3. Verify network boot, image deployment, node health, GPU visibility, and Slurm registration.
4. Run a targeted acceptance job and document a rollback path before enabling normal scheduling.

Required evidence

Capture the initial state, commands or configuration changes, relevant events and logs, health or performance output, final state, and cleanup result. Redact credentials and sensitive infrastructure data.

Success criteria

The node is healthy in Base Command Manager, visible and idle in Slurm, exposes the expected GPUs, and successfully completes the acceptance job.

Cleanup and rollback

Remove temporary workloads and credentials, return test resources to the approved baseline, and document any condition that requires escalation instead of further local changes.

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Final Review Checklist & Exam Readiness Scorecard

This section is your structured validation system before sitting for the real exam. Use it to measure readiness across the published blueprint and the hands-on operational skills expected in the performance-based portion.
It serves three purposes: validate coverage, expose specific weaknesses, and reduce exam-day risk through observable evidence rather than confidence alone.
A domain is ready only when you can explain the mechanism, select the safest action in a new scenario, and perform the representative task in a controlled lab.

Final Review Checklist

Grounded on the current NCP-AIO study guide used for this edition, the certification defines four weighted domains. Verify the latest official NVIDIA certification resources before exam day.
Use this checklist as a technical readiness review, not as a memorization list. Mark an item complete only when you can explain the mechanism and perform or troubleshoot it in a safe environment.

Administration (23%)

☐ Fleet Command - manage edge systems, application deployments, staged rollout, health, and connectivity.
☐ Slurm - interpret node and job state; manage partitions, reservations, associations, fair-share, and controlled recovery.
☐ Data-center architecture - reason about management, compute, storage, network, power, and failure domains.
☐ Run:ai - apply projects, departments, quotas, policies, borrowing, and scoped access control.

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☐ Multi-Instance GPU - configure supported profiles, advertise resources, schedule slices, and validate isolation.

Workload Management (23%)

☐ Kubernetes - troubleshoot scheduling with resources, events, labels, affinity, taints, tolerations, probes, and rollouts.
☐ GPU monitoring - use NVIDIA Data Center GPU Manager, NVIDIA System Management, and nvidia-smi to correlate health, utilization, topology, and processes.
☐ Base Command Manager provisioning - inspect images, categories, provisioning state, logs, and node readiness.

Installation and Deployment (31%)

☐ Base Command Manager - install management services, define categories, assign images, add nodes, and validate provisioning.
☐ Kubernetes through Base Command Manager - deploy and validate control-plane, worker, runtime, and GPU components.
☐ NVIDIA GPU Cloud containers - authenticate securely, pin images, verify compatibility, and run representative GPU tests.
☐ Cloud virtual machine images - validate drivers, runtime, device visibility, bootstrap automation, and reproducibility.
☐ Storage - configure supported clients, mounts, persistent volumes, throughput, latency, and workload-specific paths.
☐ DOCA on DPU Arm - validate firmware, driver, operating-system compatibility, representors, offload, and service readiness.

Troubleshooting and Optimization (23%)

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☐ Docker - isolate host-driver, NVIDIA Container Toolkit, runtime, image, and application failures.
☐ Fabric Manager, NVLink, and NVSwitch - validate service state, version compatibility, topology, links, and errors.
☐ Base Command Manager - resolve provisioning failures, configuration drift, image assignment, and hardware reachability.
☐ Magnum IO - troubleshoot NVIDIA Collective Communications Library and GPUDirect topology, transports, and dependencies.
☐ Storage performance - measure throughput, latency, queueing, metadata pressure, caching, data-loader waits, and placement.

Hands-On Readiness

☐ I can troubleshoot a Slurm-managed cluster through Base Command Manager and validate recovery with a workload.
☐ I can run and troubleshoot a Kubernetes GPU workload using Linux command-line tools and observable evidence.
☐ I can add, provision, validate, and safely release a new node through Base Command Manager.

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Exam Readiness Scorecard

Domain	Confidence (1-5)	Notes / Gaps to Review
Administration (23%)	☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆	Fleet Command, Slurm, architecture, Run:ai, and Multi-Instance GPU.
Workload Management (23%)	☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆	Kubernetes scheduling, GPU monitoring, and Base Command Manager provisioning.
Installation and Deployment (31%)	☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆	Base Command Manager, Kubernetes, containers, cloud images, storage, and DOCA.
Troubleshooting and Optimization (23%)	☆ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆	Docker, Fabric Manager, NVLink, NVSwitch, Magnum IO, and storage performance.

How to use this scorecard

Rate each domain from 1 to 5, then record the exact skills, commands, configuration decisions, or lab results that still need review.

Use the checklist and scorecard together. Prioritize Installation and Deployment, the largest weighted domain, while maintaining balanced readiness across all four domains and all three hands-on task families.

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Conclusion

Again, congratulations! You are on the right path to certification.

Use your practice results and lab evidence to decide when you are ready. Review every missed decision until you can explain the controlling mechanism, and repeat every failed lab until the success criteria are reproducible.

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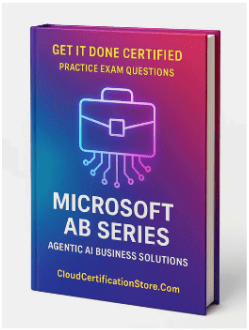
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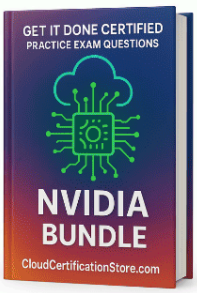
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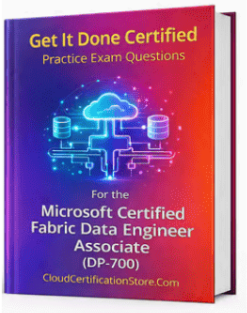
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